Printer Connectivity Explained

Why E-Zee POS prints to the Romeson RM80ZJ till printer and MRK Hotels POS currently cannot

The question in one line

E-Zee POS is a desktop program installed *on* the same computer the printer is plugged into, so it can talk directly to the printer hardware. MRK Hotels POS is a web application that runs inside a browser, and browsers are deliberately blocked from controlling hardware on other machines.

The core difference

When you press **Print** in E-Zee, a native program that lives **beside the printer** (on PC-2) hands the job to the **Windows printer driver**. The operating system gives that program full access to the printer, in the same way your computer controls any device plugged into it. There is no middle-man and no security wall — E-Zee and the printer are neighbours.

When you press **Print** in MRK, the request is made by **your web browser**. A browser can only ever touch hardware that is physically attached to the **computer it is running on**, and only through restricted, approved interfaces. It cannot reach a USB printer plugged into a **different** computer — no browser in the world is allowed to do this. That would be a serious security hole, so every browser prevents it.

Where the app runs	Can it print to the printer on PC-2?
E-Zee POS (desktop program installed on PC-2)	**Yes** — native app talks to the Windows printer driver.
MRK opened **on PC-2** itself	**No** — the printer is a vendor-driver USB device, not a standard serial device, so even a browser on PC-2 does not see it.
MRK opened **from any other device / remotely**	**No** — a browser on a remote machine cannot reach a USB printer on PC-2 at all.
A small **native helper agent** installed on PC-2	**Yes** — same pattern every cloud POS (Square, Loyverse, Toast) uses.

Notice the last row: every successful cloud/web POS reaches a local printer through a small helper. E-Zee is effectively a complete desktop program filling that role; our hosted web app currently has no such helper on the printer's computer.

What this means for MRK

MRK hotels POS is hosted in the cloud, so it can be opened from any device — that part works everywhere. But a pure browser has no legal path to a USB printer on another computer, and even on PC-2 it cannot enumerate this particular printer as a serial device. The standard, industry-accepted fix is a **small native “bridge” agent installed on the computer that owns the printer (PC-2)**. Our app safely sends a print job over the network to that agent, and the agent — because it is native — does the actual printing through the Windows driver, exactly like E-Zee. We have already added the network transport in the app; the last piece is installing that one agent on PC-2.

“What if we open MRK on PC-2’s own browser, since the printer is connected there by USB?”

My question: What if our system runs on PC-2’s own browser, with the printer connected directly to it via USB — wouldn’t that work?

The answer

This is the right instinct, and we have tested it directly. Running MRK in PC-2’s browser does unlock **USB access on that machine** — so the remoteness problem disappears. But the Romeson RM80ZJ then hits a **second, different wall: device type**.

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A browser can only see USB devices that Windows presents as a **standard serial (CDC-ACM)** device. The RM80ZJ is driven by its **own vendor-specific driver**, so it is not exposed as a standard serial device at all. That is exactly why — even in PC-2’s own browser — the port chooser showed only the earbuds and Bluetooth devices and never listed the printer.

In other words: **same machine fixes the “can I reach it” question, but the printer never appears as a selectable port because of how its driver works.** The one case where a browser app could print straight to USB is when the printer exposes a standard ESC/POS serial interface — many cheaper tills do, but the RM80ZJ does not. That is why the native helper agent on PC-2 remains the reliable route: it talks to the vendor driver the OS actually uses, which the browser cannot.

Questions to confirm the E-Zee setup

To be certain how the printer is connected to E-Zee (and how we can mirror it precisely), please answer the following:

1. Where is the printer plugged in?

Is the Romeson RM80ZJ connected to PC-2 by USB cable, by LAN/network cable, or by Wi-Fi? (The RM80ZJ supports USB and LAN.)

2. What exactly was installed for E-Zee?

During E-Zee installation, was a special printer driver or helper program installed on PC-2? If yes, do you know its name and version (e.g. the Romeson driver, or a USB-Serial driver)? This is the key detail that lets E-Zee reach the printer.

3. Is the printer set up as a Windows printer or directly by E-Zee?

In Windows, does the RM80ZJ show up under Devices & Printers as its own printer, or is it configured inside E-Zee's own “peripheral” settings only?

4. How does E-Zee connect to the printer?

Inside E-Zee's printer/peripheral settings, does it list the printer by COM port, by a LAN/IP address, or by a printer name? If you can share a screenshot of that screen, it will settle this question immediately.

5. Is E-Zee installed on PC-2, or somewhere else?

Is the E-Zee desktop app running on the same machine the printer is attached to (PC-2), or is E-Zee running on another machine that reaches the printer over the network?

6. Is there any sharing or “agent” running?

Is there any other small program or service running on PC-2 that shares the printer (for example a Windows printer share, or an E-Zee companion service in the system tray)?

7. May we install a small helper on PC-2?

To give MRK the same reach to the printer, we would install a tiny local agent on PC-2. Is that acceptable? (It only listens for print jobs we send; it has no other access.)